MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第2回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第2回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The city council approved a plan to ( ) the abandoned tram depot into an indoor farmers' market.

1 retaliate **2** renovate **3** replicate **4** reprimand

(2) Because the ferry harbor is shallow at low tide, large vessels are ( ) from entering after 4 p.m.

1 persuaded **2** promoted **3** preserved **4** prohibited

(3) Although the new packaging looks identical to plastic, it is designed to ( ) naturally in soil within months.

1 decompose **2** disappear **3** distribute **4** distinguish

(4) The orchestra's outdoor performance was postponed ( ) sudden gusts of wind that blew music stands over.

1 in contrast to **2** on behalf of **3** on account of **4** in spite of

(5) Before signing a lease on an old building, prospective shop owners should have the electrical wiring thoroughly ( ).

1 inhabited **2** inflicted **3** inserted **4** inspected

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(6) Many commuters remain (　　) about whether adding one extra bus per hour will noticeably ease morning crowding.

1 sympathetic　**2** skeptical　**3** spontaneous　**4** subordinate

(7) The university museum grants free admission to local high school students as a (　　) of goodwill toward the neighborhood.

1 glimpse　**2** garment　**3** gesture　**4** gravity

(8) Had the hikers checked the ridge weather bulletin at dawn, they (　　) caught in the afternoon hailstorm.

1 would not have been　**2** will not be　**3** had not been　**4** are not

(9) Small coastal bakeries have struggled to absorb the (　　) rise in butter and wheat prices over the past two years.

1 shallow　**2** scarce　**3** steep　**4** solemn

(10) Once you submit the online application, an automated email will be sent to (　　) receipt of your documents.

1 accumulate　**2** accompany　**3** accomplish　**4** acknowledge

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) The two research teams arrived at virtually identical conclusions completely ( ) of each other.

1 indifferently **2** independently **3** indefinitely **4** indirectly

(12) Residents near the stadium complained that illegal street parking had become a ( ) problem on match days.

1 chronic **2** courteous **3** compact **4** compatible

(13) The apprentice carpenter watched closely so as not to ( ) any subtle movement of the master's chisel.

1 overtake **2** overcome **3** overflow **4** overlook

(14) Although the software update includes dozens of minor tweaks, its chief ( ) is much faster file searching.

1 margin **2** motive **3** merit **4** menace

(15) Volunteers planted deep-rooted grasses along the slope to keep heavy autumn rain from ( ) the soil.

1 eroding **2** erupting **3** enrolling **4** enduring

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(16) Strict safety rules apply to everyone in the pottery studio, be they seasoned instructors or (　　) beginners.

1 novice　**2** complete　**3** humble　**4** vacant

(17) The town's disaster drill revealed that backup radios were (　　) when mobile networks became congested.

1 inconsiderate　**2** indispensable　**3** incompatible　**4** indistinct

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Small Bridges Disappear Quietly

Major suspension bridges attract photographers and generous maintenance budgets, yet rural road networks depend far more on thousands of short concrete and timber spans crossing narrow streams. Most drivers pass over them without noticing. Ironically, that invisibility makes routine upkeep harder to fund until serious wear sets in.

In one mountainous prefecture, inspecting every minor bridge with large crane trucks was straining town finances. Rather than lengthening intervals between checks, the prefecture trained local road crews to use compact poles fitted with cameras and mirrors. Crews photographed the underside of short spans from the riverbank and sent the images to structural engineers at headquarters. (18), specialists spent their limited travel time visiting only bridges whose photos showed early cracks or rust.

Equally effective was clearing fallen leaves and gravel from deck drains every autumn. When drains clog, rainwater pools and seeps into joints during winter freezes, accelerating corrosion. Teaching local teams what to clear before winter cost very little, yet it (19).

Decay builds through small, neglected steps. By combining low-cost screening tools with seasonal care, small municipalities found a realistic way to (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 Regardless of this
3 Otherwise
4 In this way

(19)

1 eliminated the need for structural engineers altogether
2 forced drivers to take long detours every autumn
3 extended the service life of aging spans by many years
4 made concrete heavier than steel

(20)

1 keep essential rural crossings safe within tight budgets
2 replace every stream with an underground tunnel
3 turn small timber bridges into tourist attractions
4 postpone all safety checks for twenty years

When Menu Descriptions Shape Food Waste

Restaurants frequently look to portion sizes when trying to cut plate waste, yet how a dish is described on a menu can be just as influential. Diners often order an unfamiliar item based on an appealing title, only to leave half of it untouched upon discovering a strong herb, a spicy sauce, or an unexpected texture.

A university dining hall tested this idea after noticing that trays returning from lunch lines carried large amounts of uneaten vegetable stews. Interviews showed that students were not opposed to plant-based dishes; rather, poetic menu names such as "Autumn Harvest Bowl" gave no clue that the dish contained bitter greens and coriander. Staff rewrote the labels to highlight sensory details—for example, "Roasted Squash Bowl with Crisp Bitter Greens and Lemon-Herb Dressing"—and placed tiny tasting spoons at the counter. (21), plate waste from featured stews fell by nearly a third within a month.

Clearer descriptions also reduced pressure during peak lunch minutes. Previously, servers spent time answering repetitive ingredient questions while the queue grew impatient. With key flavors and common allergens stated plainly at eye level, students decided faster before reaching the counter. (22), the tasting spoons encouraged hesitant diners to try unfamiliar seasonings without risking a full serving they might dislike.

The dining team concluded that reducing waste did not require shrinking meals or limiting variety. Often, waste occurred simply because (23). Giving diners honest, specific expectations helped match each plate with someone who would genuinely enjoy finishing it.

(21)

1 Even so
2 In the meantime
3 By contrast
4 As a result

(22)

1 Moreover
2 Otherwise
3 Instead
4 Previously

(23)

1 portions at university cafeterias were too small
2 diners lacked the information needed to choose what suited their taste
3 students refused to eat any dish containing roasted squash
4 servers gave out too many tasting spoons

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Guidelines for the Shared Makerspace

From: K. Morita, Workshop Coordinator
To: Registered Makerspace Users
Subject: New 3D-printer booking system and unattended runs

Dear users,
Over the past semester, demand for our two 3D printers and laser cutter has doubled, leading to long waits before project deadlines. Starting November 1, users must upload their print file to the booking portal before reserving a time slot; the portal estimates run time automatically so nobody books a four-hour slot for a forty-minute part.

Prints lasting up to ninety minutes require you to remain in the workshop the entire time. Longer prints may run unattended during daytime hours only if you stay for the first twenty minutes to confirm that the base layer has adhered properly to the build plate—most print failures and nozzle jams occur during that initial stage. All machines shut down at 7:00 p.m. sharp; overnight printing is not permitted for fire-safety reasons.

Filament spools stored in the cabinet are shared for small prototypes under fifty grams. If your design exceeds fifty grams, please purchase a personal spool at the campus store or bring an approved PLA spool with its specification label intact. Unlabeled plastics can melt at the wrong temperature and damage the heating unit.

Best regards,
K. Morita

Guidelines for the Shared Makerspace — Questions

(24) Why must users upload their print file before reserving a machine slot?

1 So staff can redesign every student's prototype.

2 To check whether the file was created on a home computer.

3 So the system can calculate actual print duration and prevent overbooking.

4 Because the laser cutter can no longer read USB drives.

(25) Under what condition may a print lasting longer than ninety minutes run unattended?

1 The user watches the first twenty minutes during daytime hours to verify base adhesion.

2 It starts after 7:00 p.m. and finishes before morning.

3 The user pays an extra fire-safety deposit at the campus store.

4 The part weighs more than fifty grams.

(26) Why are unlabeled plastic spools banned from the printers?

1 They cost more than spools sold at the campus store.

2 Their colors fade under workshop lights.

3 They may melt at an improper temperature and harm the heating unit.

4 They cannot produce parts lighter than fifty grams.

Cold Storage Powered by Winter Air

Keeping harvested apples, potatoes, and root vegetables fresh through spring and summer requires steady, cool temperatures and high humidity. Modern warehouses achieve this with electric refrigeration, which works reliably in any climate but consumes substantial power—especially during hot months when cooling units must run hardest and electricity prices peak.

In parts of northern Japan, agricultural engineers and storage cooperatives have refined an older regional idea: capturing winter cold in massive insulated rooms filled with snow or ice blocks gathered between January and March. As outdoor temperatures climb in spring, fans circulate air past the stored snow and into adjacent produce rooms. Far from being a nostalgic curiosity, contemporary snow-cooled warehouses use digital sensors and motorized dampers to hold storage rooms within a single degree of zero Celsius.

This approach offers biological advantages alongside energy savings. Standard mechanical refrigerators cool air by passing it over subzero metal coils, a process that strips moisture from the room and can leave apples shriveled or potatoes sprouting prematurely. Air cooled by melting snow, by contrast, naturally stays above ninety percent humidity without extra humidifiers. In blind taste tests and texture measurements, certain varieties of rice, buckwheat, and root crops stored in snow rooms retain crispness and natural sweetness longer than counterparts kept in conventional chillers.

Snow cooling clearly has geographic and practical limits. Mild winters can reduce local snowfall, hauling heavy snow requires fuel, and building thick insulated chambers demands higher upfront construction spending than installing a standard compressor. Even in snowy districts, cooperatives often keep backup electric chillers for late August when stored snow finally runs low.

Still, where winter weather provides abundant snow right beside farmland, treating it as a seasonal resource rather than a road-clearing nuisance turns a costly winter burden into summer cooling capacity. The revival of snow warehouses illustrates how modern control technology can make passive, local energy sources commercially competitive.

Cold Storage Powered by Winter Air — Questions

(27) How do modern snow-cooled warehouses maintain steady temperatures?

1 By opening warehouse doors every night during summer.

2 By burying apples directly in uninsulated outdoor fields.

3 By spraying liquid nitrogen over wooden crates twice a day.

4 By using digital sensors and motorized dampers to regulate air blown past stored snow.

(28) Why do apples and root crops often stay fresher in snow-cooled rooms than in standard mechanical refrigerators?

1 Mechanical refrigerators keep rooms above twenty degrees Celsius.

2 Snow-cooled air naturally keeps high humidity instead of drying produce out.

3 Melting snow adds artificial sugar to the skin of the fruit.

4 Light inside snow rooms helps potatoes continue growing leaves.

(29) Which limitation of snow-cooled storage is acknowledged in the fourth paragraph?

1 Digital sensors cannot function near zero degrees Celsius.

2 Buckwheat and rice spoil within a week in humid air.

3 Upfront building costs are higher and backup chillers may be needed in late summer.

4 Snow collected in January melts completely before April arrives.

(30) Why do some cooperatives in snowy districts still install electric chillers?

1 Because snow rooms are illegal to operate in July.

2 To provide backup cooling in late August when stored snow runs low.

3 To freeze fresh apples solid before shipping them.

4 Because local farmers refuse to harvest crops in autumn.

(31) What broader lesson does the author draw from the revival of snow warehouses?

1 All southern cities should import snow by truck every winter.

2 Electric refrigeration has no value in any climate.

3 Traditional farming methods work best when all modern instruments are removed.

4 Modern control systems can turn local, passive natural resources into practical commercial solutions.